



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*dharmādharmau sukhaṃ duḥkhaṃ mānasāni na te bibho |
na kartā+asi na bhoktā+asi mukta evā+asi sarvadā || 1 | 6 |*

— Aṣṭāvakraḡītā, Prakaraṇa 1 (Chapter 1), Verse 6

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This verse strikes at the very heart of our perceived reality, dismantling the structures of suffering we often build around ourselves. Astavakra is directly telling Janaka, and by extension you, that the concepts of righteousness and unrighteousness, pleasure and pain, are purely mental constructs, and they do not truly touch your essential being. You are not the doer, not the enjoyer, but are eternally free.

Think about it: how much of your daily experience is dictated by the pursuit of pleasure and the avoidance of pain? We chase after things we believe will bring us happiness, and run from situations that cause us discomfort. We judge our actions and the actions of others as either good or bad, right or wrong, creating a constant inner dialogue of moral evaluation. This verse suggests that these judgments are merely overlays on the pure, unblemished canvas of your true self.

The statement that you are not the 'doer' challenges your deeply ingrained sense of agency. You likely believe that you are in control of your actions, making conscious choices that shape your life. However, Astavakra is hinting at a deeper truth: that your actions are often driven by ingrained patterns, conditioned responses, and the momentum of past karma. Recognizing this can liberate you from the burden of responsibility and the guilt of perceived failure.

Similarly, the assertion that you are not the 'enjoyer' suggests that true happiness does not come from external sources. The pleasures we experience are fleeting and transient, always leaving us wanting more. True joy, according to this verse, resides within you, independent of external circumstances. You are already free, eternally unbound by the limitations of the mind. This freedom is not something you need to achieve; it is your inherent nature. In modern life, this translates to detaching from the relentless pursuit of external validation and finding peace in your own being, regardless of your circumstances.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

If you are not the doer or the enjoyer, then who are you, truly, beyond the labels and experiences that define your perceived self?